

mood, typically making them feel persistently sad, dejected, and anxious.

desensitization

The lessening of a person's sensitivity and emotional response to a negative stimulus following frequent exposure to it.

digital footprint

A trail of digital data that is a record of a person's online activity.

discrimination

Treating a person unfairly as a result of prejudice, for reasons including race, gender, or religion.

divorce

The legal way of ending of a marriage.

echo chamber

A filtering system, such as that used on social media websites, whereby users are only exposed to select news and information sources based on their online activity that reinforce their already-existing opinions.

ejaculation

The sudden discharge of fluid from the genitals, usually as a result of sexual activity.

emergency contraception

A hormone-based contraception that prevents pregnancy, used only after protection has failed or following unprotected sex.

emotion

The body's instinctive response to something happening to or around a person.

empathy

The ability to see things from another person's perspective, and to understand and share his or her emotions.

endorphins

A hormone, released in the brain that lessens the feeling of pain and improves a person's mood.

equality

The state of being equal and fair, such as all people having the same rights regardless of their race or religion.

erection

The firm and enlarged state of a penis when filled with blood, often caused by sexual arousal.

erogenous zone

A highly sensitive area of the body that is packed with nerve endings, and which can cause sexual arousal when stimulated.

extremism

Having ideas and views that are extreme, or that differ considerably from what most people think to be correct or reasonable.

flaccid

The state of the penis when soft and not erect.

fertilization

The joining of sex cells (a male sperm and female egg) to create a zygote—a cluster of cells that, over time, forms a baby.

firewall

A digital security system that protects a person's computer from unauthorized access, such as from hackers.

foreplay

Intimate acts, such as kissing and touching, between two individuals that stimulate sexual arousal, sometimes (but not always) before sex.

gay

Being sexually attracted to

members of the same sex; also called homosexual.

gender

A combination of a person's biological sex, gender expression, and gender identity.

gender dysphoria

A condition in which an individual feels that their biological sex does not match their gender identity.

gender expression

The way individuals present themselves to society, through their appearance and behavior.

gender identity

The way individuals personally think, feel, and see themselves as a man, woman, or other gender.

genitals

A person's external sexual organs—the penis and testicles of a male, and a female's vulva.

germ cell

An egg or a sperm.

gestation

The period of time, from conception to birth, during which a baby develops inside a female's uterus.

gland

An organ that produces and releases chemicals, such as hormones, into the body.

grooming

When a person pretends to be someone or something that they are not, in order to earn trust and manipulate another person into doing something.

groping

When a person touches someone else in a sexual way, over or under clothing, without their consent.

gynecomastia

Enlargement of a male's "breasts" due to a change in hormone levels during puberty; often referred to as "man boobs" or "moobs."

heterosexism

The assumption that an individual is sexually attracted to people of the opposite sex.

heterosexual

A person that is sexually attracted to members of the opposite sex; also known as straight.

homophobia

Showing prejudice against people who are gay.

homosexual

A person who is sexually attracted to members of the same sex; also called gay.

hormone

A chemical (such as estrogen or testosterone) produced by the body that controls and regulates the activities of specific cells in the body.

hypothalamus

An area of the brain that triggers puberty by releasing the GnRH hormone.

identity

The distinguishing qualities and characteristics of a person, such as nationality, personality, gender, interests, and culture.

identity theft

The criminal act of obtaining and using another individual's personal details.

implantat

When a fertilized egg attaches itself to the wall of the uterus.

independence

Freedom of actions and